

AI Tips

App, model, effort. The setup is done. Everything from here is just what you type into the box.

And everyone types into the same box. Some people get noticeably more back than everyone else, and it isn't because they found the magic words. There are no magic words. What they have is a short list of moves they run on purpose, most of them one sentence long.

None of these are tricks, and none of them expire. Five moves. Steal all five.

THE MOVE ALMOST NOBODY TRIES

AI can't see your class, your teacher, your deadline, or the two things you already decided. Most people handle that by typing more. There's a faster way: make it ask you.

Make it interview you.

● YOU

Before you write anything, ask me whatever you need to know about me and this assignment to do it well. One question at a time.

● AI

Happy to. First one: what did the assignment actually ask for, in your teacher's words?

Answer four or five of those and it knows more about the job than you would ever have thought to type. And the questions are the bonus: they tell you what mattered that you hadn't considered.

FOUR MORE MOVES

Same shape every time: one sentence, typed on purpose, at the moment it fits.

1 Tell it what you already tried.

Ask cold and you get the average answer, and the average answer is usually the thing you already did. Rule out your dead ends in the prompt and the model has to go past them.

"Here's the problem. I already tried [X] and [Y]. X changed nothing, Y made it worse. Skip both and tell me what else could be going on."

2 Ask for options, not an answer.

One answer and you're stuck grading its pick. Several, and you're choosing again, which was always the part that was yours.

"Give me five ways I could do this, ranked, with the tradeoff on each. Don't pick for me."

When something is broken instead of undecided, same move, different shape: "Give me three possible explanations for why this is happening, most likely first."

3 Say what wrong looks like.

"Try again" gets you a different flavor of the same miss. The model can't see what bothered you. Name it, keep the part that worked, and point the next try somewhere.

"Not this. The tone is off. Keep the first paragraph, cut the hype, and make it sound like a text, not a newsletter."

4 Start a new chat instead of arguing with the old one.

Once a chat goes sideways, the wrong turn is still sitting in there, getting re-read before every new word. Twenty messages of correcting just adds more of it. Take the good part with you and leave the rest behind.

"Summarize what we've settled so far in one paragraph I can paste into a new chat."

NOTICE WHAT ALL FIVE HAVE IN COMMON.

Not one of them hands the work over. They pull your situation out of your head, rule out the dead ends you already found, widen the options before you pick, and aim the next try. The AI does more in every one of them, and so do you.

There are no magic words.

Just five moves, run on purpose.